

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 21

By Walley

A RESOLUTION to honor the memory of Linda Ann Harkey
Bowling of Olive Hill.

WHEREAS, the members of this General Assembly were greatly saddened to learn of the passing of Linda Ann Harkey Bowling; and

WHEREAS, Linda Bowling was an exemplary public servant and consummate professional who worked assiduously to improve the quality of life for her fellow citizens in numerous capacities; and

WHEREAS, born in Waynesboro on April 27, 1948, Mrs. Bowling was the daughter of Allen and Mary Len Harkey, and she spent her formative years on Hardin's Creek; and

WHEREAS, Mrs. Bowling was a proud graduate of Frank Hughes School, where she played basketball during a time when girls only played half court; she earned a bachelor's degree from the University of Tennessee at Martin and a master's degree from the University of North Alabama; and

WHEREAS, Linda Bowling began her estimable teaching career at Frank Hughes School and briefly taught home economics; she went on to teach kindergarten for more than thirty years, earning the respect and admiration of her colleagues and students before taking her much-deserved retirement in 2006; and

WHEREAS, Mrs. Bowling was deeply devoted to her family, and she always endeavored to remain true to family values of the highest order; she was known for her love of cooking, her Sunday dinners, and her yeast rolls, which were made from a secret family recipe; and

WHEREAS, Linda Bowling enjoyed the loving companionship of her husband of forty-seven years, Larry Bowling; also left to cherish her memory are her daughters, Nicole (Brian) Wilkerson and Lauri (Keith) Wilkerson; her grandchildren, Callie, Crew, Landrey, and Lynzley;

her sister, Barbara Wilburn; her brother, David Harkey; and a host of nieces, nephews, cousins, and friends; and

WHEREAS, in addition to her parents, Linda Bowling was preceded in death by her brother, Jim Harkey; and her brother-in-law, Ronnie Wilburn; and her niece, Angie Bryant; and

WHEREAS, she was also deeply committed to her faith and attended Olive Hill Baptist Church, where she taught Sunday School, sang in the choir, and assisted with Vacation Bible School; additionally, she served as chaplain of the Retired Teachers Association in Wayne County; and

WHEREAS, Linda Bowling leaves behind an indelible legacy of integrity and probity in public life, compassion and loyalty in private life, and diligence and dedication in all her chosen endeavors; and

WHEREAS, it is fitting that the members of this General Assembly should pause to remember the bountiful life of this exceptional public servant and human being; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we honor the memory of Linda Ann Harkey Bowling, reflecting fondly upon her impeccable character and her stalwart commitment to living the examined life with courage and conviction.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that we express our sympathy and offer our condolences to the family and friends of Mrs. Bowling.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.